

COMPLIANCE

IT & Security Policy

Purpose

This policy establishes guidelines for acceptable use of SWS AI's IT systems, data security practices, and incident response procedures. All employees must comply with this policy from Day 1.

Acceptable Use of IT Resources

Company-issued devices and systems must be used primarily for work purposes. Limited personal use is tolerated but must not:

- Involve illegal activities.
- Compromise device security.
- Consume excessive bandwidth.
- Include installation of unauthorized software.

Password Policy

All passwords must:

- Be at least 12 characters long.
- Include uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters.
- Be unique across different systems.
- Be changed every 90 days.
- Never be shared with colleagues.

Use the company-approved password manager (1Password) for storage.

Data Classification

SWS AI data is classified into 4 levels:

1. **Public** – Can be shared freely (marketing materials, blog posts).
 2. **Internal** – For employees only (policies, general communications).
 3. **Confidential** – Limited access (client data, source code, financial data).
 4. **Restricted** – Highly sensitive (credentials, PII, trade secrets).
- Always handle data according to its classification level.
- Approved Communication Tools**
- SWS AI uses the following company-approved tools for workplace communication:
- Slack: primary instant messaging and team channels
 - Google Meet and Zoom: video meetings and client calls
 - Google Workspace (Gmail): formal email communication
 - Jira: project tracking and engineering workflows
 - GitHub: source code collaboration

Device Security

All company devices must:

- Have full-disk encryption enabled.
- Run the latest OS and security patches.
- Have the company endpoint security software installed.
- Use screen lock (max 5-minute timeout).
- Never have unauthorized USB devices connected.

Access Control

Access to systems and data is granted on a need-to-know basis. Employees must:

- Not share login credentials with anyone.
- Not use another employee's credentials.
- Report lost or stolen devices immediately.
- Request access revocation for colleagues who have left the company.

Incident Response

If you suspect a security incident:

1. Do not panic or try to fix it yourself.
2. Immediately notify your manager and IT security team.
3. Preserve evidence — do not delete logs or files.
4. Document what you observed (time, what happened, affected systems).
5. Cooperate fully with the IT investigation.

Cloud & Data Storage

All work files must be stored in company-approved cloud storage (Google Drive / AWS S3). Personal cloud storage (personal Dropbox, iCloud, etc.) must not contain company data. Sensitive data must never be emailed externally without encryption.

Third-Party Tools

Installation of third-party software or browser extensions on company devices requires prior IT approval. Unapproved software may introduce vulnerabilities and will be removed remotely.